

THE NEW CARRIER FMCSA SURVIVAL GUIDE

Ground 0 · 16 Deadly Sins · New Entrant Audit Checklist

A step-by-step system for building audit-ready compliance
before FMCSA shows up at your door.

FREE DIAGNOSTIC: [launchpathedu](#)

Most new carriers don't see the audit coming.

FMCSA conducts a New Entrant Safety Audit within the first 18 months of your authority being active.

Fail it — and your operating authority is revoked.

- No warning. No second chance on first revocation.
- Most failures are from missing documents, not bad driving.
- The FMCSA tells you exactly what they want — most carriers ignore it.

Two numbers. One decision.

COST OF REMEDIATION AFTER FAILURE

\$10,000

— \$25,000

Legal fees + corrections + re-audit costs

COST OF THE COMPLETE DOCUMENT SYSTEM

\$499

Install it yourself. One-time payment.

The system costs less than one hour of legal remediation.

You have 18 months.
The clock starts when your authority goes active.



FMCSA auditors check 6 domains: Driver Qualification · Drug & Alcohol · HOS · Vehicle Maintenance · Insurance · Accident Records

Start here.

Before you buy anything. Before you build anything.

Ground 0 is a free orientation module. It takes 20 minutes.
It answers the question every new carrier skips:

"Do I understand what I am actually building — and what it protects?"

- What FMCSA authority really means (and what exposes it)
- The order of operations: REACH → Ground 0 → Four Pillars → Modules
- Why 80% of new entrant failures are structural, not behavioral
- What happens if you skip the foundation and go straight to paperwork

BEGIN GROUND 0 FREE → launchpathedu.com/ground0

Every new carrier is audited across 6 domains.

Missing documentation in any one of these can trigger a conditional or unsatisfactory rating.

DOMAIN 01 DRIVER QUALIFICATION DQ files, MVR CDL, medical cert, road test	DOMAIN 02 DRUG & ALCOHOL Testing policy, MRO random program, records	DOMAIN 03 HOURS OF SERVICE Logs, ELD dispatch records, violation tracking
DOMAIN 04 VEHICLE MAINTENANCE PM schedule, DVIR inspection records, repairs	DOMAIN 05 INSURANCE & AUTHORITY FMCSA filings, coverage types lapse prevention	DOMAIN 06 ACCIDENT RECORDS Accident register, post-accident testing reports

16 patterns that reach the authority.

These are not random mistakes. They are recurring, preventable failures that weaken, expose, or damage new carriers during the New Entrant period.

They reach the authority four ways:

A — AROUND

Bypassing controls entirely

U — UNDER

Slipping through undetected gaps

T — THROUGH

Breaking through weak documentation

O — OVER

Overloading the system until it collapses

SIN 01

No DQ File System

Drivers operating without proper qualification files on record

SIN 02

Missing Drug & Alcohol Policy

Operating without a written, DOT-compliant D&A program

SIN 03

No Random Testing Consortium

Required random testing pool not established before first driver

SIN 04

HOS Log Gaps

Missing or incomplete hours-of-service records for inspected drivers

SIN 05

Lapsed ELD Compliance

ELD malfunctions not documented or corrected within required window

SIN 06

No Pre/Post-Trip DVIRs

Driver Vehicle Inspection Reports missing or unsigned

SIN 07

PM Schedule Not Documented

No preventive maintenance intervals established in writing

SIN 08

Insurance Lapse Window

Gap between policy cancellation and replacement filing

SIN 09

No Accident Register

Accidents not logged in a DOT-required written register

SIN 10

Post-Accident Testing Missed

Failed to test driver after qualifying accident within window

SIN 11

Authority Registered Wrong

MC/DOT authority filed under wrong entity or wrong address

SIN 12

No Operating Authority on File

MCS-150 or OP-1 not updated after material changes

SIN 13

Driver File Incomplete

Missing road test certificate, MVR, or annual review

SIN 14

No Written Safety Policy

Carrier operating without a documented safety management plan

SIN 15

Leased Driver Not on Program

Owner-operator under lease not in D&A consortium

SIN 16

MCS-150 Not Biennial Filed

Operating authority invalidated by missed biennial update

The audit is a document audit.

Not a road inspection. Not a surprise. A structured document review.

FMCSA publishes exactly what they will look for. Most carriers have never read it.

- Pass = authority remains active
- Conditional = 60 days to correct deficiencies
- Unsatisfactory = authority revocation proceedings begin
- The standard is not high — but you have to actually have the documents

"The system does not fail carriers. Carriers fail themselves by not building the system."

— Vince Lawrence, Founder LaunchPath EDU

What FMCSA looks for:

- Driver Application (49 CFR 391.21)
- Motor Vehicle Record — MVR (391.23)
- Medical Examiner's Certificate — current (391.41–391.45)
- Road Test Certificate or equivalent (391.31)
- Annual Driving Record Review (391.25)
- Driver's License copy (391.11)
- Previous employer safety performance history (391.23)
- Clearinghouse query results (382.701)

LP-PKT-DQ

DQ FILE BUILDER

- Pre-built DQ file folder
 - All 8 required forms
- CFR-cited instructions
 - Audit-ready format
 - \$129 one-time

GET THE DQ FILE BUILDER →

What FMCSA looks for:

- Written Drug & Alcohol policy (49 CFR 382.601)
- Random testing consortium enrollment (382.305)
- Pre-employment testing record (382.301)
- Reasonable suspicion training for supervisors (382.603)
- Post-accident testing procedures documented (382.303)
- SAP referral records if applicable (382.605)
- MRO contact information on file

Deadly Sin #02 — No written policy | Sin #03 — Not enrolled in consortium

These are the two most cited D&A violations in New Entrant audits.

DOMAIN 03: HOS & DISPATCH

- ELD device registered + functioning (395.8)
- Driver logs — 6 months minimum (395.8)
- HOS violation documentation (395.3)
- Time zone records for interstate ops

DOMAIN 04: VEHICLE MAINTENANCE

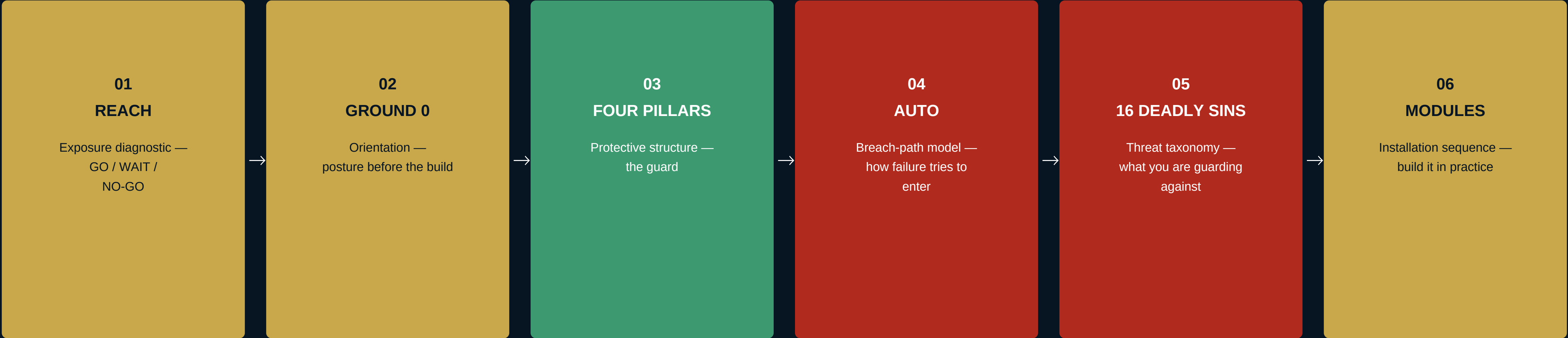
- Preventive maintenance schedule written (396.3)
- Driver Vehicle Inspection Reports — DVIR (396.11)
- Annual inspection records per vehicle (396.17)
- Repair orders for DVIR defects (396.11)

DOMAIN 05: INSURANCE & AUTHORITY

- MCS-90 endorsement on file (387.7)
- BMC-91 or BMC-91X (cargo insurance) (387.301)
- FMCSA proof of insurance filing current
- Authority registration — biennial MCS-150 filed

Six steps. One system.

The order is not optional.



"REACH reveals exposure. Ground 0 forms posture. Pillars build the guard. AUTO maps the breach. Sins name the threats. Modules install the protection."

90 days. 5 domains. 5 checkpoints.

90

Days to full installation

5

Compliance domains

5

Custodian checkpoints

What you walk away with after 90 days:

- A complete Driver Qualification file system
- A DOT-compliant Drug & Alcohol program
- HOS records architecture and ELD protocol
- A written Preventive Maintenance schedule
- Insurance and authority filing discipline
- A Verified Registry ID confirming completion

RECOMMENDED FOR MOST CARRIERS

The Complete Document System Bundle

\$499 — one-time payment

- **All 5 domain compliance packets**
\$323 value individually
- **Folder architecture + file naming system**
Audit-ready organization
- **0–30–60–90 implementation calendar**
Paced installation roadmap
- **Master compliance checklist**
Single-page audit prep summary

INDIVIDUAL DOMAIN PACKETS

New Entrant Safety	\$109
DQ File Builder	\$129
Drug & Alcohol	\$129
HOS & Dispatch	\$119
Vehicle Maintenance	\$119
Individual total:	\$605

Bundle price: **\$499**

You save \$106

Before you spend a dollar — know where you are exposed.

The REACH Diagnostic is a free 15-minute assessment that maps your current compliance exposure across all 6 FMCSA domains.

GO

You are ready to build. Proceed to Ground 0.

WAIT

Gaps identified. Address flagged areas first.

NO-GO

Significant exposure. Stop and remediate before proceeding.

FREE REACH DIAGNOSTIC → launchpathedu.com/reach

Built by someone who has watched this break in the real world.

Vince Lawrence — Navy veteran. OSHA-certified. 25+ years operational leadership.

Navy Veteran

OSHA-Certified Safety Professional

25+ Years Operational Leadership

Founder, LaunchPath EDU

"LaunchPath is not a course funnel. It is a governed standard. The system either protects the authority or it does not."

Three paths. Start where you are.

01

NOT SURE WHERE YOU STAND?

Take the free REACH Diagnostic.

launchpathedu.com/reach-diagnostic

02

READY TO ORIENT?

Start Ground 0 — free, 20 minutes.

launchpathedu.com/ground-0-briefing

03

READY TO INSTALL?

Get the Document System Bundle.

launchpathedu.com/compliance-library

The system either protects
the authority —
or it doesn't.

launchpathedu.com | FMCSA Compliance for New Motor Carriers

FREE REACH DIAGNOSTIC → launchpathedu.com/reach-d